83. With reference to 'IFC Masala Bonds', sometimes seen in the news, which of the statements given below is /are correct ?

1. The International Financed Corporation, which offers these bonds, is an arm of the World Bank.
2. They are the rupee-denominated bonds and are source of debt financing for the public and private sector.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (c): The World Bank Group (WBG) consists of five organizations-IBRD, IDA, IFC, MIGA and ICSID. International Finance Corporation (IFC) is a member of the World Bank Group (WBG) and at the same time, it's called as the World Bank's private- sector lending arm with a stated objective to ensure that any financing does not result in harm to communities and the environment.
IFC Masala Bond : The first Masala bond was issued by IFC in 2014 for infrastructure projects in India. They are the rupee-denominated bonds issued to offshore investors and are a source of debt financing for the public and private sectors.

84. In the context of which of the following do you sometimes find the terms 'amber box, blue box and green box in the news?

(a) WTO affairs
(b) SAARC affairs
(c) UNFCCC affairs
(d) India –EU negotiations of FTA

Ans. (a): In WTO terminology, subsidies, in general, are identified by "Boxes" which are given the colours of traffic lights. Green (permitted), Amber (slowed down, i.e, reduced) and Red (forbidden).

85. Recently, which one of the following currencies has been proposed to be added to the basket of IMF's SDR?

(a) Ruble (b) Rand
(c) Indian Rupee (d) Renminbi

Ans. (d): In the most recently concluded review (November 2015), the Executive Board of IMF decided that effective 10 October, 2016, the Chinese Renminbi (RMB) will be included in the SDR basket as a fifth currency, along with the US Dollar, Euro, Japanese, Yen and Pound Sterling.

86. 'Net metering' is sometimes seen in the news in the context of promoting the

(a) production and use of solar energy by the households/consumers.
(b) use of piped natural gas in the kitchens of households.
(c) installation of CNG kits in motor-cars.
(d) installation of water meters in urban household.

Ans. (a) : A net metering is a billing mechanism that credits solar energy system owners for the electricity they add to the grid. Net metering allows residential and commercial customers who generate their own electricity from solar power to feed electricity they do not use back into the grid.
Under, net metering system, customers install a solar or a wind power plant on his premise, gets its grid - connected with the electricity distribution company (DISCOM).

87. Recently, our scientists have discovered a new and distinct species of banana plant which attains a height of about 11 metres and has orange-coloured fruit pulp. In which part of India has it been discovered ?

(a) Andaman Islands
(b) Anaimalai forests
(c) Maikala Hills
(d) Tropical rain forest of northeast

Ans. (a): Scientists at the Botanical Survey of India (BSI) discovered the new species of banana from a remote tropical rain forest on the Little Andaman islands. The new species has Orange-Coloured fruit pulp and is about 11 meters high, whereas the usual banana species is about three to four meters high.

88. Which one of the following is the best description of 'INS Astradharini, that was in the news recently?/`INS

(a) Amphibious warfare ship
(b) Nuclear-powered submarine
(c) Torpedo launch and recovery vessel
(d) Nuclear – powered aircraft carrier

Ans. (c): INS Astradharini is an indigenously designed built torpedo launch and recovery vessel built by a shoft shipyard for the Indian Navy. It was commissioned to the Indian Navy on 6th October 2015 at Naval Base in Visakhapatnam.

89. What is 'Greased Lightning-10 (GL-10)', recently in the news ?

(a) Electric plane tested by NASA
(b) Solar–powered two-seater aircraft designed by Japan
(c) Space observatory launched by China
(d) Reusable rocket designed by ISRO

Ans. (a) : The Greased Lightning or GL-10 is the electric plane with 10 engines tested by NASA that can take off and land like a helicopter and fly efficiently like an aircraft.

90. 'Doctors Without Borders (Medecins Sans Frontieres)', often in the news, is

(a) A division of World Health Organization
(b) a non-governmental international organization
(c) an inter-governmental agency sponsored by European Union
(d) a specialized agency of the United Nations

Ans. (b) : Doctors Without Borders or Medecins Sans Frontiers is a non-profitable international medical humanitarian organisation created by doctors and journalists in France in 1971. MSF gives emergency aid to people affected by wars, epidemics, famine, natural disasters, man-made disasters, or areas where there is no healthcare available. It provides this help to all people, regardless of their race, religion or political beliefs. In 1999 Doctors Without Borders was awarded the Noble Peace Prize.

91. 'Belt and Road Initiative' is sometimes mentioned in the news in the context of the affairs of

(a) African Union (b) Brazil
(c) European union (d) China

Ans. (d): The 'One Belt One Road' imitative has also been referred to as the Belt and Road Initiative (BRI), which was announced in 2013 by China's President Xi Jinping.

- The 'Belt' also refers to the 'Silk Road Economic Belt'. The objective of the imitative is to improve sub-regional and regional cooperation.
- It aims to connect the East Asian economic regions with the European economic circle and runs across the continents of Asia, Europe and Africa.

Miscellaneous

92. Which of the following is/are the indicator/ indicators used by IFPRI to compute the Global Hunger Index Report ?

1. Undernourishment
2. Child stunting
3. Child mortality

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1, 2 and 3
(d) 1 and 3 only

Ans. (c) : Four indicators are undernourished population, wastage in children under 5; waste in form of very low height, i.e, very small child; stunting in children under 5; stunting is very low height for age, i.e. very short child, mortality rate under 5.

93. With reference to the International Monetary and Financial Committee (IMFC), consider the following statements :

1. IMFC discusses matters of concern affecting the global economy , and advises the International Monetary Fund (IMF) on the direction of its work.
2. The World Bank participates as observer in IMFC's meetings.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (c): Statement 1 : The IMFC advises and reports to the IMF Board of Governors on the supervision and management of the international monetary and financial system, including on response to unfolding events that may disrupt the system.
Statement 2 : A number of international institutions, including the World Bank, participate as observers in the IMFC's meetings.

94. With reference to 'Organization for the prohibition of Chemical Weapons (OPCW)' consider the following statements :

1. It is an organization of European Union in working relation with NATO and WHO.
2. It monitors chemical industry to prevent new weapons from emerging.
3. It provides assistance and protection to Stated Parties against chemical weapons threats.

Which of the statements given above is /are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (c) : The Organization for the Prohibition of Chemical Weapons is the Hague-based autonomous body, which was established in 1977 by the Chemical weapons Convention, not EU.
The OPCW Member states share the collective goal of preventing chemistry from ever again being used for warfare thereby strengthening international security.

95. With reference to the 'Trans-Pacific Partnership', consider the following statements :

1. It is an agreement among all the Pacific Rim countries except China and Russia.
2. It is a strategic alliance for the purpose of maritime security only.

Which of the statements given above is /are correct ?

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2